

Slocum Ballasting Checklist

Mission: _____ **Glider S/N:** _____

Engineer: _____ **Date:** _____

Source

Paraphrased from the *Slocum G3 Glider Maintenance Manual* (Chapter 3, "Ballasting"). See the [Ballasting Procedure](#) for the full explanation of each step.

1. Before Powering Up

- ☐ Glider closed with a proper vacuum — ≥ 6 in Hg shallow / ≥ 7 in Hg deep
- ☐ PEEK MS plug torqued to 15 in-lb
- ☐ Ballast tank filled, large enough to fully submerge the glider, and a way to lift it in/out confirmed

2. Setting Ballast Mode

- ☐ Power the glider (external 15 VDC or green go-plug)
- ☐ If in PicoDOS: `app` to start GliderDOS
- ☐ `Ctrl-C` to gain control
- ☐ `callback 30`
- ☐ `lab_mode on`
- ☐ `ballast` — confirm pump/pitch vernier at 0 and bladder deflated
- ☐ Science sensors live for tank density (`loadmission sci_on.mi` or the `c_science_* puts`)